WEIGHT 11

Orlistat

Gut lipase inhibitor that blocks the digestion of dietary fat; acts in the stomach and small intestine



CLASS
Lipase inhibitor

STUDIED FOR
Weight, diabetes prevention

HUMAN EVIDENCE
Large trials; FDA approved

US STATUS
FDA approved (Xenical; Alli OTC)

STUDIED FOR

- **Body weight** — HUMAN
- **Diabetes prevention** — HUMAN

Two strengths, two channels. Xenical 120 mg is prescription-only; Alli 60 mg is sold over the counter to overweight adults.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Orlistat ▶ Gut lipases off ▶ Fat not absorbed ▶ Fewer calories

- **Binds and switches off** lipases in the stomach and small intestine (label)
- **Undigested fat** is not absorbed and passes out in the stool
- **Fewer calories** are taken in as a result
- **Acts in the gut;** systemic exposure is minimal

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

FDA APPROVED
LEVEL 5 OF 5

- 2-year European trial: 743 adults
- XENDOS: 3,305 adults, 4 years
- Many people did not finish the trials

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- PK in kidney or liver disease

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE
1 to 2 hours for absorbed orlistat (limited data, label)

ROUTES STUDIED
By mouth (capsules), with fat-containing meals

PHARMACOKINETICS
Minimal absorption; about 97% of a dose leaves in feces

SOLD AS
Prescription capsules (Xenical); over the counter (Alli)

MONITORED IN TRIALS
Weight; HIV viral load if on HIV drugs (label)

SPORT (WADA)
Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	Approved: Xenical 1999 (Rx), Alli 2007 (OTC)
DEA	Not a controlled substance
EMA	Authorised: Xenical 1998, Alli 2007
WADA	Not prohibited

REFERENCES

1. FDA, Xenical prescribing information, Jan 2026
2. Torgerson et al., XENDOS, Diabetes Care, Jan 2004
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

Adonis Men's Health · checked Nov 2026. Research and regulator records only. Not medical advice.

adonismenshealth.com